

SYED ABDULLAH HASSAN

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Coventry, United Kingdom | Open to relocation

PROFILE

MSc Cyber Security Engineering student at the University of Warwick with around two years of commercial software engineering experience, moving into security. Practical work across detection engineering, SIEM investigation, cloud and container security, penetration testing and digital forensics. Comfortable writing detection logic and tuning it, reconstructing an incident from endpoint and network telemetry, and validating findings before acting on them. Engineering background means security problems get treated as systems problems.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security Monitoring and Detection: Splunk (SPL), Wazuh, Sysmon, Microsoft Defender, Windows Event Logs, alert triage, incident investigation, log correlation, detection rule development, alert tuning, threat hunting, MITRE ATT&CK, MITRE D3FEND

Cloud and Container Security: AWS, Docker, Docker Compose, Kubernetes, Trivy, Gype, Dockle, Hadolint, Docker Bench Security, container hardening, CVE analysis, CIS Benchmarks, NIST SP 800-190, OWASP Top 10

Offensive Security: Nmap, Metasploit, Burp Suite, sqlmap, Gobuster, ffuf, Netcat, Kali Linux, penetration testing, privilege escalation, PTES, OWASP Testing Guide, CVSS

Digital Forensics: Autopsy, FTK Imager, Registry Explorer, JumpList Explorer, ShellBag Explorer, disk image analysis, artefact correlation, timeline reconstruction, evidence handling

Risk and Governance: Threat modelling, risk assessment, risk registers, IEC 62443, ISO 27001, ISO 27005, NIST CSF, ISO 21434, UK NIS Regulations, GDPR, CVSS, remediation planning

Networking and Identity: TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, VPN, SMB, OSPF, VLANs, ACLs, firewalls, network segmentation, role based access control, AAA and TACACS+

Engineering: Python, Bash, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL, REST APIs, Git, CI/CD, Node.js, React, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Linux, Windows

SECURITY PROJECTS AND RESEARCH

Early Ransomware Detection Cyber Range | *MSc Dissertation, in progress*

- Built an isolated cyber range across a Kali Linux attack host, a Windows 11 endpoint and an Ubuntu server running Wazuh.
- Collecting telemetry from Microsoft Defender, Sysmon, Windows Event Logs and network monitoring to capture endpoint, identity and network signals from the same attack.
- Measuring detection latency and alert coverage across simulated attack scenarios, and mapping techniques to MITRE ATT&CK to find where coverage is real and where it is thin.

Detection Engineering and Incident Investigation | *Proactive Cyber Defence, MSc*

- Investigated a simulated ransomware incident in Splunk, correlating Sysmon process events, Windows Event Logs, SMB traffic and HTTP data to rebuild the attack chain from initial access to impact.
- Traced entry to a malicious upload through a web application, found the brute force attempts before it, and quantified impact at 257 files encrypted on the file server and 406 on the endpoint.
- Wrote five Splunk detection rules covering suspicious upload, brute force, abnormal outbound traffic, mass file operations and script interpreter abuse, each mapped to MITRE ATT&CK.
- Documented tuning guidance for every rule, covering thresholds, allow listing and log enrichment, to keep false positives manageable.

Infrastructure and Web Application Penetration Test | *Ethical Hacking, MSc, 42 page report*

- Assessed three hosts under PTES and the OWASP Testing Guide, rating 15 vulnerabilities against CVSS, 3 critical, 7 high and 5 medium, with prioritised remediation.
- Chained template injection into remote code execution, escaped the container to the host, escalated through three misconfigurations to root, and exploited MS17-010 for SYSTEM on a legacy Windows host.

Container Security and Vulnerability Management | *Cloud Security, MSc*

- Reduced unique known vulnerabilities in a containerised application by roughly 85 to 90%, rescanning after each change instead of assuming the fix held.
- Found a scanner discrepancy where package database scanning missed 25 vulnerabilities that binary fingerprinting caught, which is why I now treat single source findings as unconfirmed.
- Applied runtime hardening including dropped Linux capabilities, non root users, resource limits and network segmentation, mapped to CIS Docker Benchmark and NIST SP 800-190.

Risk Assessment and Threat Modelling | *Compliance, Risk and Governance, MSc*

- Ran an independent risk audit of a UK vehicle manufacturer across ten operational technology assets, comparing five risk frameworks before selecting and applying IEC 62443.
- Partitioned the estate into five security zones with conduits and target security levels set by threat actor capability, and wrote an asset specific threat scenario for every device.
- Built a risk register triaging CVEs by CVSS, likelihood and impact, and produced a remediation plan with named owners, timelines and residual risk, including compensating controls where no vendor patch existed.

Digital Forensic Examination | *Digital Forensics, MSc*

- Examined a Windows disk image, verifying supplied hashes and keeping the image read only throughout to protect evidential integrity.
- Worked through 853 recovered emails to 29 relevant ones, then correlated registry keys, web history, shellbags and jumplists to attribute activity and build a timeline.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SOFTWARE ENGINEER

GoSaaS Labs (Renesas, Fluke, Tektronix clients) | Jul 2023 to Aug 2025

- Investigated and resolved production incidents across enterprise platforms serving three global clients, working from application behaviour, system logs and error output under time pressure.
- Led a security overhaul on a document archiving platform, building the control into the existing developer workflow rather than bolting it on.
- Built role based access control and secure search from scratch, so users only reached data they were cleared for.
- Deployed and managed services on AWS with Docker and Kubernetes across CI/CD pipelines.
- Built and maintained backend services and REST APIs in Node.js, React, PostgreSQL and MongoDB, and improved application performance by around 30% by refactoring legacy aggregation pipelines.
- Mentored two junior developers through onboarding and kept team documentation current.

DATABASE LAB INSTRUCTOR

FAST, National University of Computer and Emerging Sciences | Jan 2024 to Jul 2025

- Taught database systems to over 100 students and was the person they came to when something broke, adapting the explanation to whoever was asking.

ASSOCIATE SOFTWARE ENGINEER

Infinikorn (promoted from intern within 2 months) | Oct 2022 to Dec 2022

- Built and maintained web applications using Ruby on Rails, PostgreSQL and Docker.

EDUCATION

University of Warwick | *MSc Cyber Security Engineering, 2025 to Expected Sept 2026*

Modules: Proactive Cyber Defence, Ethical Hacking, Cloud Security, Network Security, Digital Forensics, Applied Cryptography, Compliance, Risk and Governance

FAST, National University of Computer and Emerging Sciences | *BSc Computer Science, 2019 to Aug 2023*

CERTIFICATIONS AND TRAINING

- CompTIA Security+, scheduled for 2026
- Oracle Cloud Infrastructure 2023 AI Certified Foundations Associate
- AWS Cloud Practitioner Essentials (AWS Skill Builder)